

Read, Respond, and Teach: A Reader-Response Analysis and Lesson Plan Task

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When I first read *The Arrow and the Song*, I honestly thought it was just a simple poem about an arrow and a song being thrown into the air. But after reading it again a few times, I started to feel like it's actually about something more personal—like how what we do or say can reach people even if we don't see it happen.

The line "I shot an arrow into the air, / It fell to earth, I knew not where" made me think of situations where I said something without really thinking. There were moments in real life where I didn't expect my words to matter much, but later I found out they actually did. It's kind of like the arrow—you release it and you just don't know where it lands anymore.

Then in the second stanza, "I breathed a song into the air," it felt more emotional to me. I didn't really see it as an actual song, but more like words or feelings you give to someone. I remember times when someone said something simple but it stayed in my mind for a long time. So when it says "who has sight so keen and strong, / That it can follow the flight of song?" I understood it as saying we can't really track how our words affect others, especially emotionally.

The ending part is what stood out most to me. The speaker finds the arrow again, still unbroken, which kind of surprised me because I expected it to be gone or damaged. But what really stuck with me was "I found again in the heart of a friend." For me, that line felt like the poem is saying that good things we say don't really disappear—they stay with people. At least from my own experience, I tend to remember how people made me feel more than the exact words they used.

Overall, I think the poem is reminding us that both actions and words have effects we don't always see. My interpretation is influenced by my own experiences with people, especially moments where I realized something I said or heard stayed longer than expected. I guess the poem made me think more about being careful, but also kind, with what I "send out" to others.

LESSON PLAN – GRADE 9

Objectives

At the end of the 40-minutes discussion, the students must be able to

- identify their understanding of the poem *The Arrow and the Song* using relevant textual evidence;
- present a personal response connecting the poem's ideas to their own life experiences; and
- demonstrate appreciation of the poem by sharing a personal reflection on how its message relates to their life.

Subject Matter

Topic: *The Arrow and the Song* through the Reader-Response Approach

Materials: Powerpoint Presentation, Instructional Materials, Laptop, Television

Reference: <https://www.poetryfoundation.org/poems/44624/the-arrow-and-the-song>

Values Infused: Responsibility, empathy, and respect in using words and actions that affect others.

Procedure

Routine Activities

- Prayer
- Greetings
- Attendance
- Classroom Management

Review

- What are literary devices?
- How do literary devices like imagery or symbolism help readers understand a poem's meaning?

Motivation

Title: *Words That Stay?*

Instruction: The teacher will ask the students to reflect on a personal experience where someone's words or actions had an impact on them--whether positive or negative--by answering the question "*Think of a time when someone's words or actions stayed in your mind for a long time. What happened, and how did it make you feel?*" Students will be given time to think and write their responses on a short piece of paper or in their notebook. Afterward, selected students will be invited to share their answers with the class, followed by a brief interactive discussion where students react and relate to each other's experiences.

Lesson Proper

A. Introduction of the poem

The Arroe and the Song

By Henry Wadsworth Longfellow

I shot an arrow into the air,
It fell to earth, I knew not where;
For, so swiftly it flew, the sight
Could not follow it in its flight.

I breathed a song into the air,
It fell to earth, I knew not where;
For who has sight so keen and strong,
That it can follow the flight of song?

Long, long afterward, in an oak
I found the arrow, still unbroke;
And the song, from beginning to end,
I found again in the heart of a friend.

B. Guide questions:

- What line or image stood out to you? Why?
- What did you feel while reading the poem?
- What do you think the poem is trying to say based on your first impression?

C. Brief Discussion of Key Concepts

1. Lyric Poetry

- A type of poem that expresses personal feelings or thoughts.
- It is often short and emotionally expressive.

2. Symbolism (Simple explanation)
 - A literary device where objects represent deeper meanings.
 - Example: an object or image can represent an idea or feeling.
3. Reader-Response Perspective
 - A way of understanding literature where meaning is created by the reader.
 - Different readers may have different interpretations based on their experiences.
 - Meaning is mainly created by the readers from the text.

Application

Title: *Message in Motion!*

Instruction: The teacher will divide the class into four groups. Each group will be tasked to create a short presentation (role-play or creative skit) that represents their own interpretation of the poem *The Arrow and the Song*, focusing on the symbolic meaning of the “arrow” and the “song” based on their personal experiences.

Each group will decide how these symbols apply in real-life situations and present a scenario that reflects how words or actions can affect others.

After the presentation, each group must explain:

- what their “arrow” and “song” represent;
- what personal experiences influenced their interpretation; and
- how their presentation connects to the message of the poem.

The rest of the class will listen and observe, noting similarities and differences in each group’s interpretation.

Generalization

- What message did you get from the poem?
- How did your experience affect your understanding?
- How will this guide your actions or words?

Evaluation

Exit Ticket

Direction: answer the following in 2–3 sentences.

1. What message did you personally get from the poem?
2. Which line supports your understanding?
3. How does the poem relate to your own experience?

Assignment

Title: *If I Were the Arrow or the Song...*

Direction: Choose ONE perspective: either the arrow or the song in the poem. Then write a short paragraph (5–7 sentences) answering:

- If you were the arrow/song, what would your story be?
- What kind of impact would you want to leave on others?
- How does this connect to your own life or behavior?